

# BROADCAST NEWS VALUE MATRIX

Basic Broadcast Technology & Editorial Gatekeeping Reference Framework

**Broadcast News Evaluation:** Unlike print or digital text, broadcast journalism requires evaluating potential stories through both **editorial relevance** and **technical feasibility**. Master Control, Field Crews, and Assignment Editors use this matrix to balance story weight against transmission bandwidth, audio/video capture quality, and live production capability.

## News Value & Technical Integration Matrix

| News Value             | Editorial Criteria                                                                          | Broadcast Technology & Production Focus                                                                                    | Broadcast Example                                                                              |
|------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Timeliness & Immediacy | Events happening right now; fresh information relevant to the immediate broadcast block.    | Live cellular bonding units (LiveU/Dejero), low-latency satellite links (DSNG), real-time lower-third graphics automation. | Breaking field report on a major highway shutdown delivered live during the 5:00 PM newscast.  |
| Visual & Audio Appeal  | Stories driven by compelling motion imagery, strong B-roll, and clean ambient audio.        | 4K camera framing, wireless lavalier/shotgun mic feeds, multi-cam switching, real-time radar or 3D graphics overlay.       | Severe weather breakdown utilizing live field video paired with interactive studio radar maps. |
| Impact & Scope         | Direct consequences affecting a large percentage of the station's broadcast viewing area.   | Emergency Alert System (EAS) override, master control crawl integration, high-bandwidth studio feed prioritization.        | Grid-wide regional power outage impacting 250,000 local utility customers.                     |
| Proximity              | Events occurring within the station's direct Designated Market Area (DMA) or coverage zone. | Mobile ENG vans, localized microwave transmitters, regional studio feeds, geographic lower-third locator tags.             | City council voting on a local property tax rate increase affecting municipal school budgets.  |
| Prominence             | Focus on high-profile public figures, official institutions, or widely recognized figures.  | Multi-box podium audio taps (press mult-box), remote press conference switching, dual studio anchor setups.                | Live gubernatorial address regarding state infrastructure funding priorities.                  |
| Conflict & Tension     | Disagreements, political debates, or opposing viewpoints requiring balanced airtime.        | Dual field standup split-screen ('box effect'), multi-channel IFB earpiece communication, live audio mixing.               | Live studio debate between two mayoral candidates on commercial zoning regulations.            |
| Human Interest         | Emotional, relatable, or inspirational stories that connect on a personal viewer level.     | Controlled studio/field lighting (three-point lighting), warm microphone EQ profiles, shallow depth-of-field lenses.       | Profile on a local community center providing free hot meals and job training.                 |

## Production QA Checklist for Broadcast Readiness

- 1. Technical Gatekeeping:** Does the field feed meet minimum SNR (Signal-to-Noise Ratio) and video frame stability standards for live air?
- 2. Editorial Verification:** Is the story verified through at least two independent primary sources prior to triggering on-screen breaking banners?
- 3. Asset Allocation:** Does the story warrant assigning a dedicated live truck/cellular bonding pack versus pre-recorded B-roll playback?